| INTERVIEWEE: J. Franklin Hyde

INTERVIEWER: James J. Bohning

LOCATION: Marco Island, Florida

| DATE: 30 April 1986

| BOHNING: Dr. Hyde, you were born on 11 March 1903 in Solvay, NY.
| Could you tell me something about your parents?

| HYDE: My father's name was Burton Deforest Hyde and was in the
; sand and gravel business. My mother was born Amelia Bennett.
| Solvay is a small village, a suburb of Syracuse, and it's the
location of the Solvay Process Company. Although a small town,
it was also home for a number of other industries, Frazier and

Jones, Malleable Iron Castings, Pass and Seymour Insulator Works, | Hammond Steel Company, and the Iroquois Pottery Company. My Dad

had, along with thé sand and gravel business, the equipment used
| to unload clay from the canal boats along the nearby Erie Canal.
We used to unload coal cars, for instance, for the Hammond Steel
Company. As soon as I was big enough to handle a shovel or drive
j a team of horses, I got plenty of outdoor exercise during the
summers.

I was named after my two grandfathers, but I never knew
| them. One was James Bennett. I discovered, only recently, his
discharge papers from the army. He was a sergeant in Sheridan's
cavalry during the Civil War. I guess he was taken prisoner and
| spent some time in Libby Prison, which is I think, a suburb of
Richmond. I don't know too much about my grandparents. My
grandmother's name on my mother's side was Childs, Lucy Childs.
I knew my grandmother on my father's side very well because she
| -lived with us for many years. Her name was Martin, Lydia Ann Martin. She was born in Sandy Creek, Oswego County, between
Syracuse and Watertown. I know some of the family history.
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BOHNING: Did you have any brothers and sisters?

HYDE: Yes, I have an older brother, Solon W. Hyde. Back in those days, they used to name their kids after famous people. My brother was named after my father's uncle, who was Solon Webster Martin. My grandmother had several brothers, one of them was Henry Clay Martin, and another George Washington Martin. I hada Sister, Helen Hyde Darby, who passed away many years ago.

BOHNING: You lived in Solvay, and went to school there?

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